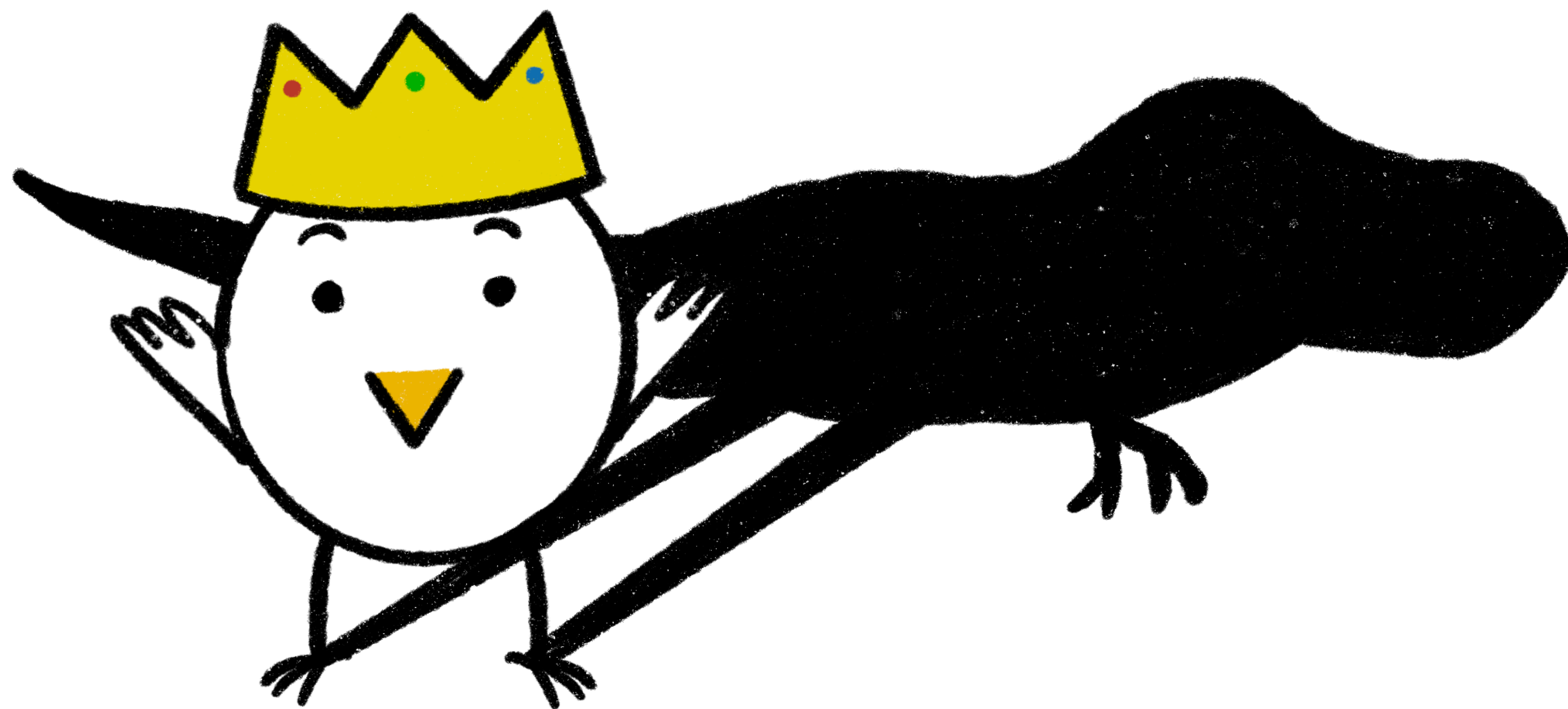


# King Clucky

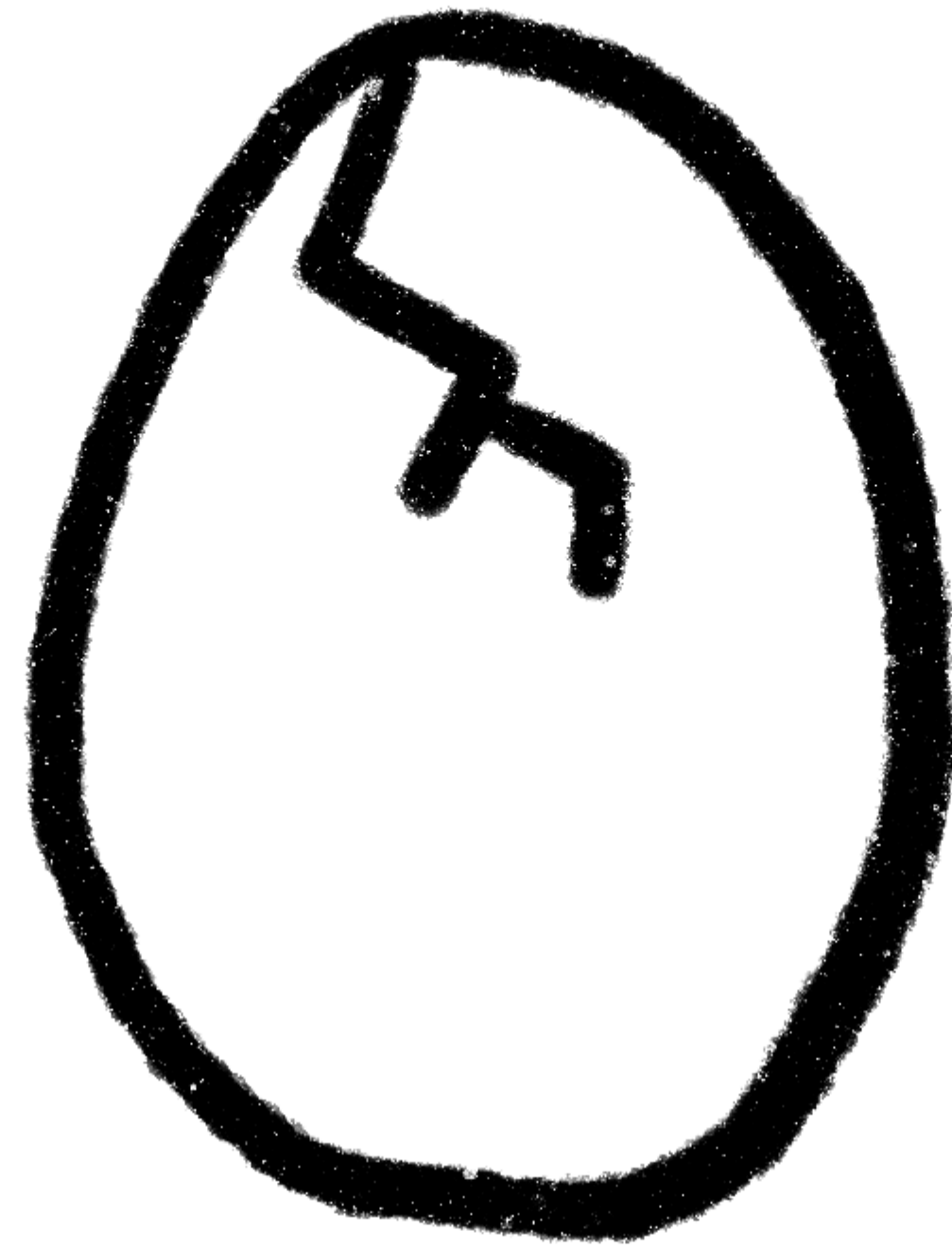


Written and Illustrated by Matthew Kim

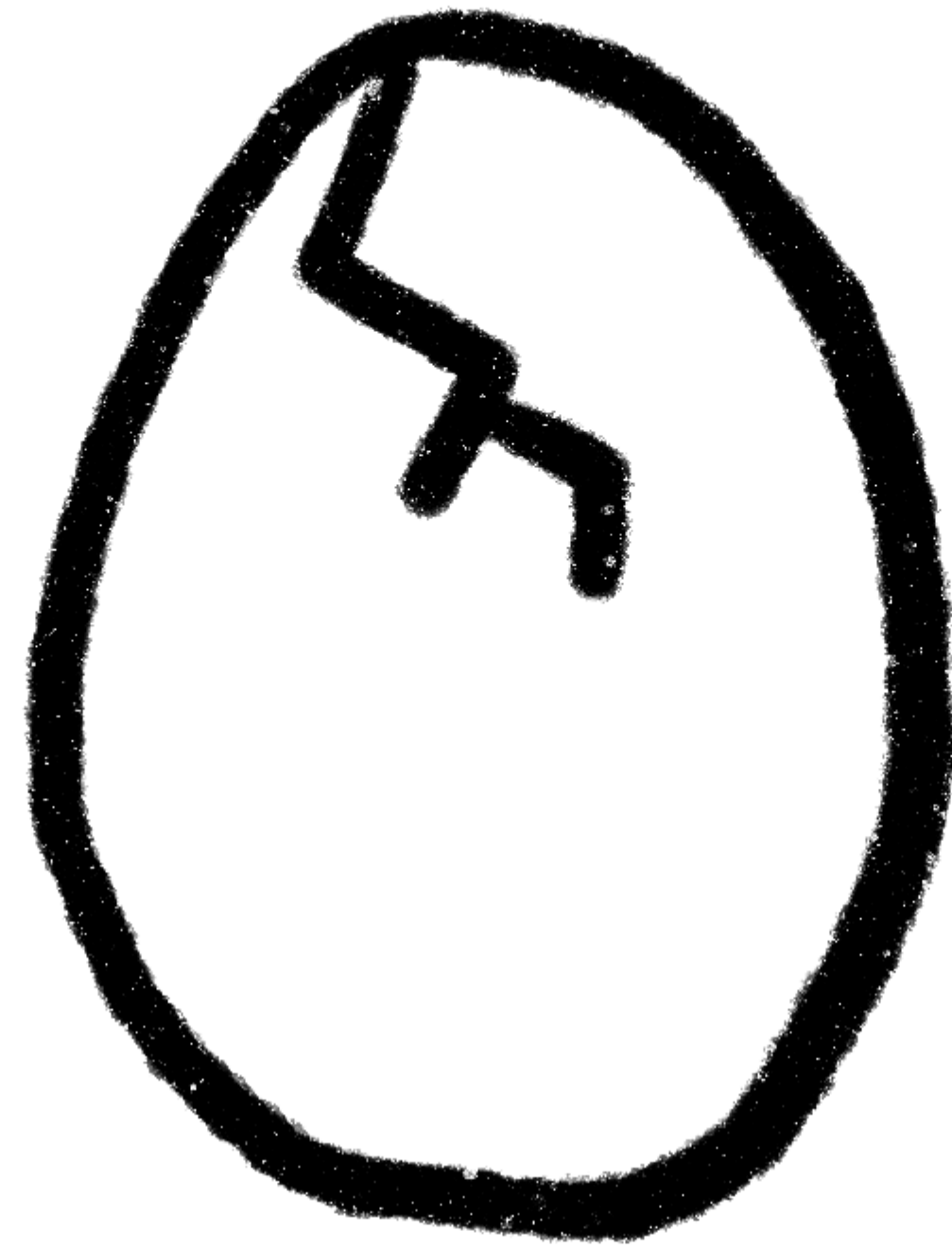










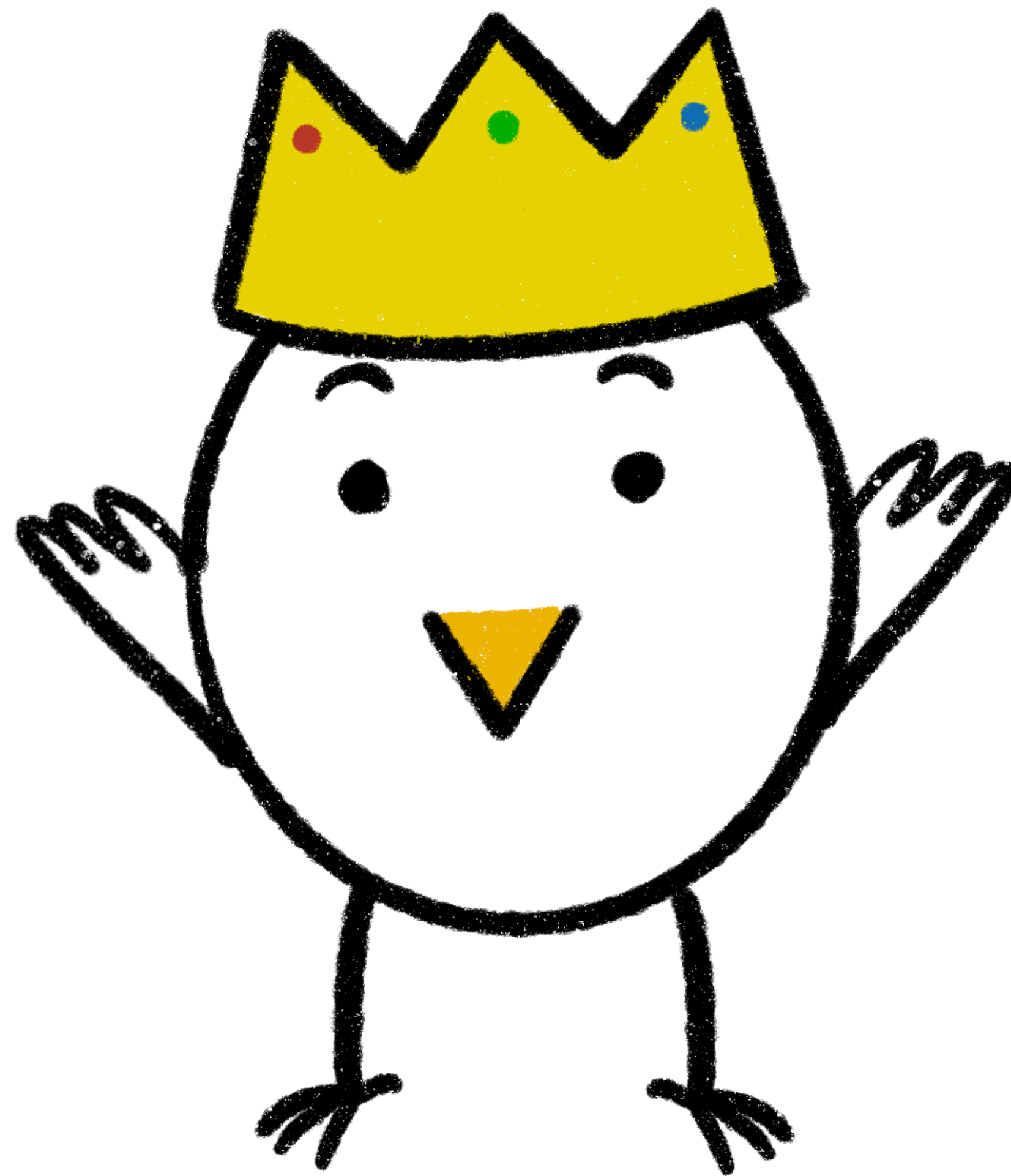




To Richard "Gussy,"  
My harshest critic.



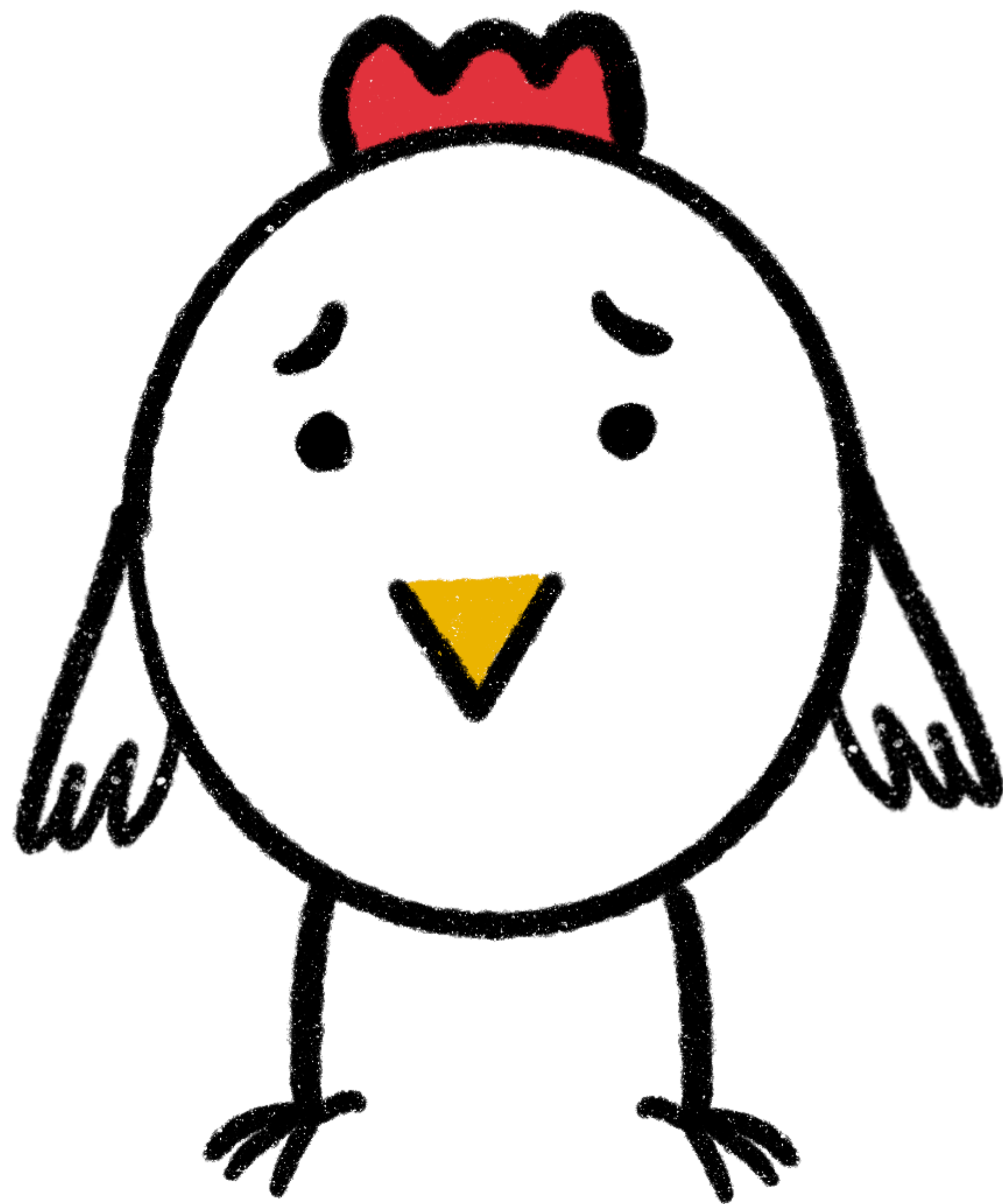
# King Clucky



Written and Illustrated by Matthew Kim



Clucky is a chicken, no less, no more.  
He finds himself to be an exhausting bore.





His ancestry book stands 10 gnomes tall,

Yet all he can do is bawl.



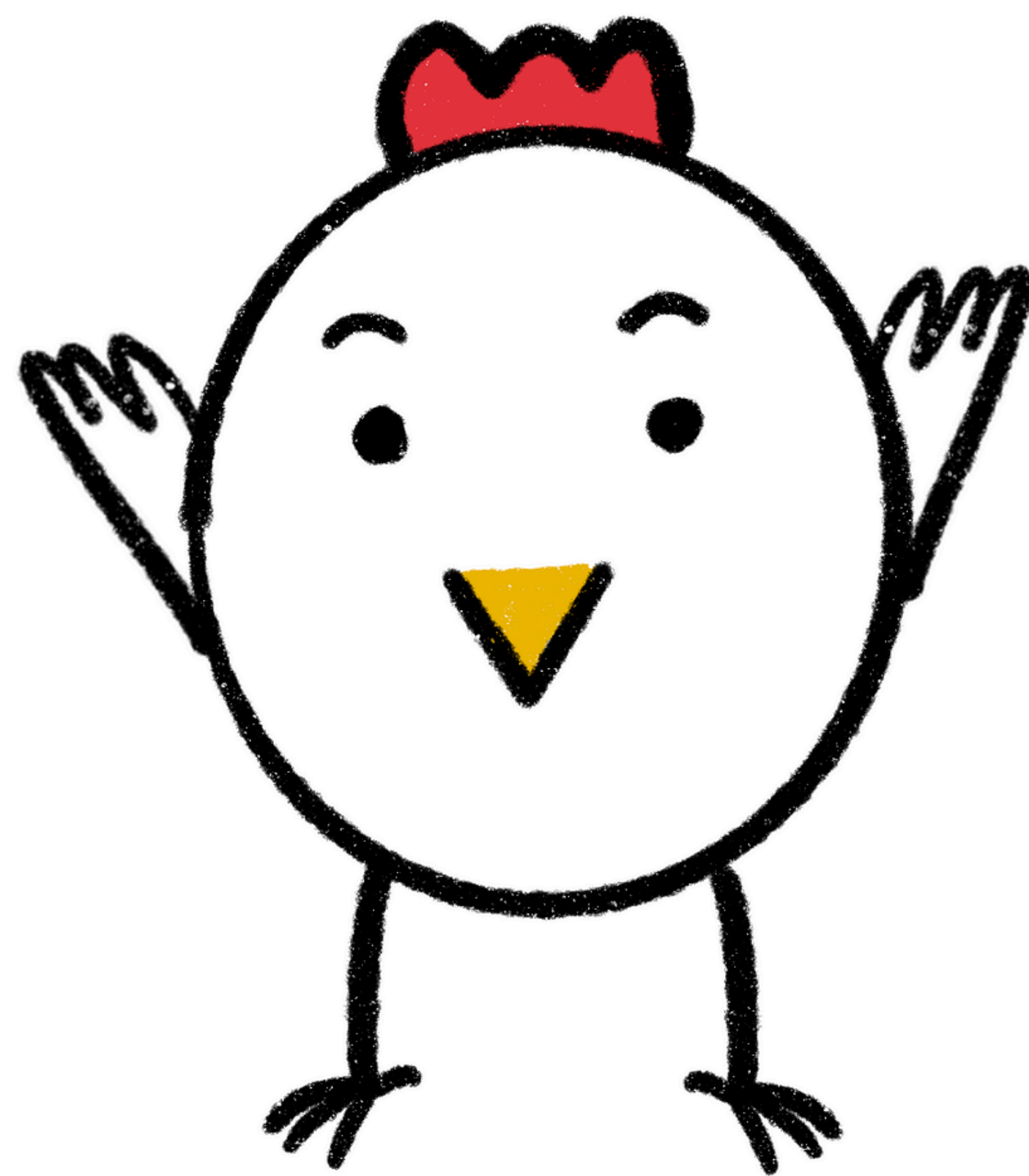
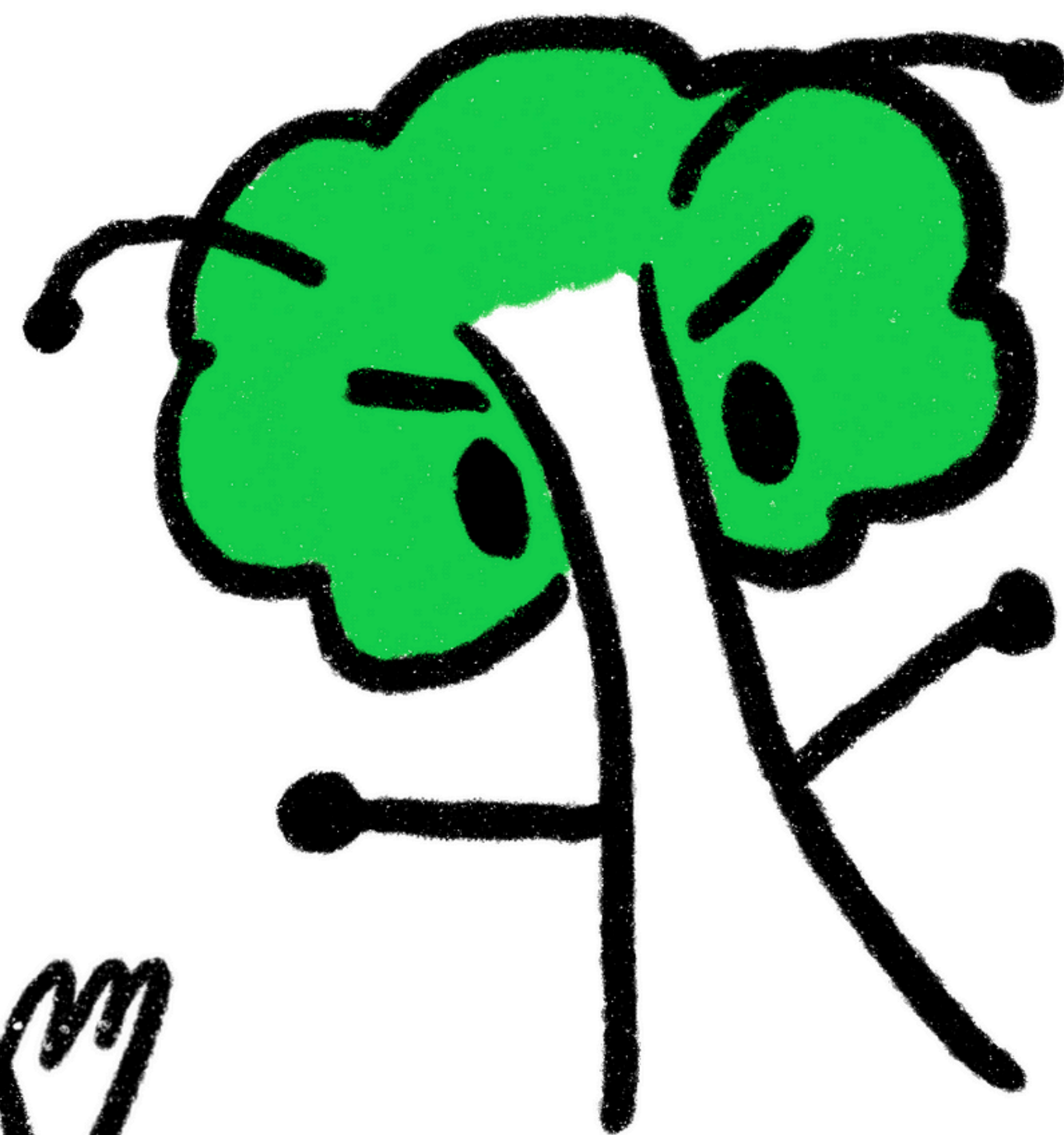
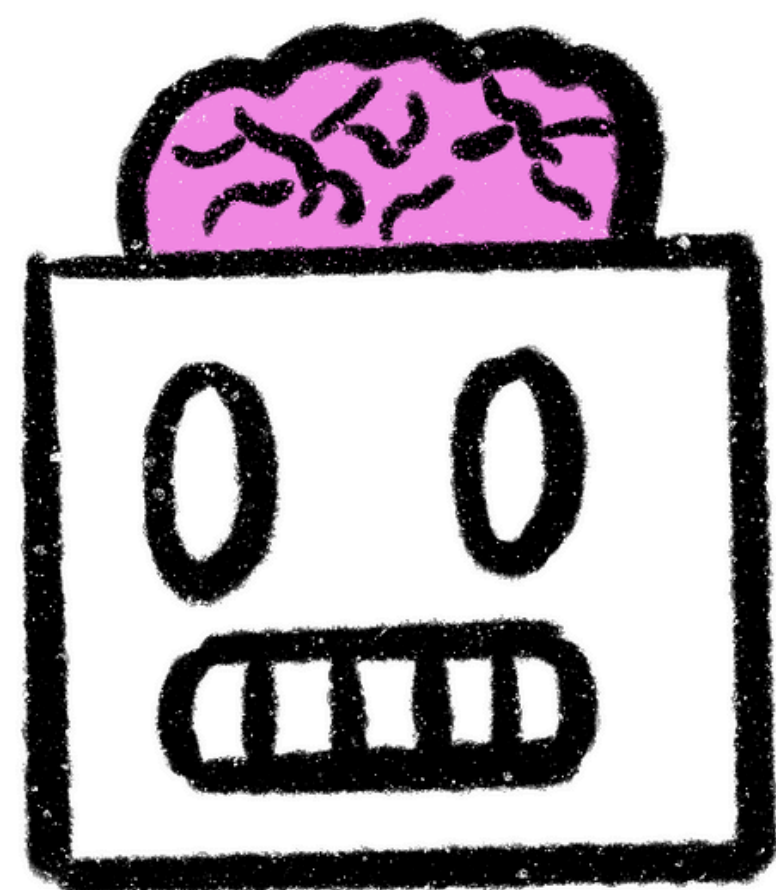


You see, Clucky descends from the mightiest of kings,  
But all he has is a lame pair of wings.  
He wallows in pity, sad and gloom,  
Then realizes with a sense of doom—  
All his dino grandparents, every last one,  
Are fossilized relics, long since gone.





What fate did they claim?  
Who is to blame?  
Robotic zombies?  
Vengeful alien trees?



Clucky is curious.

"It must've been serious!"

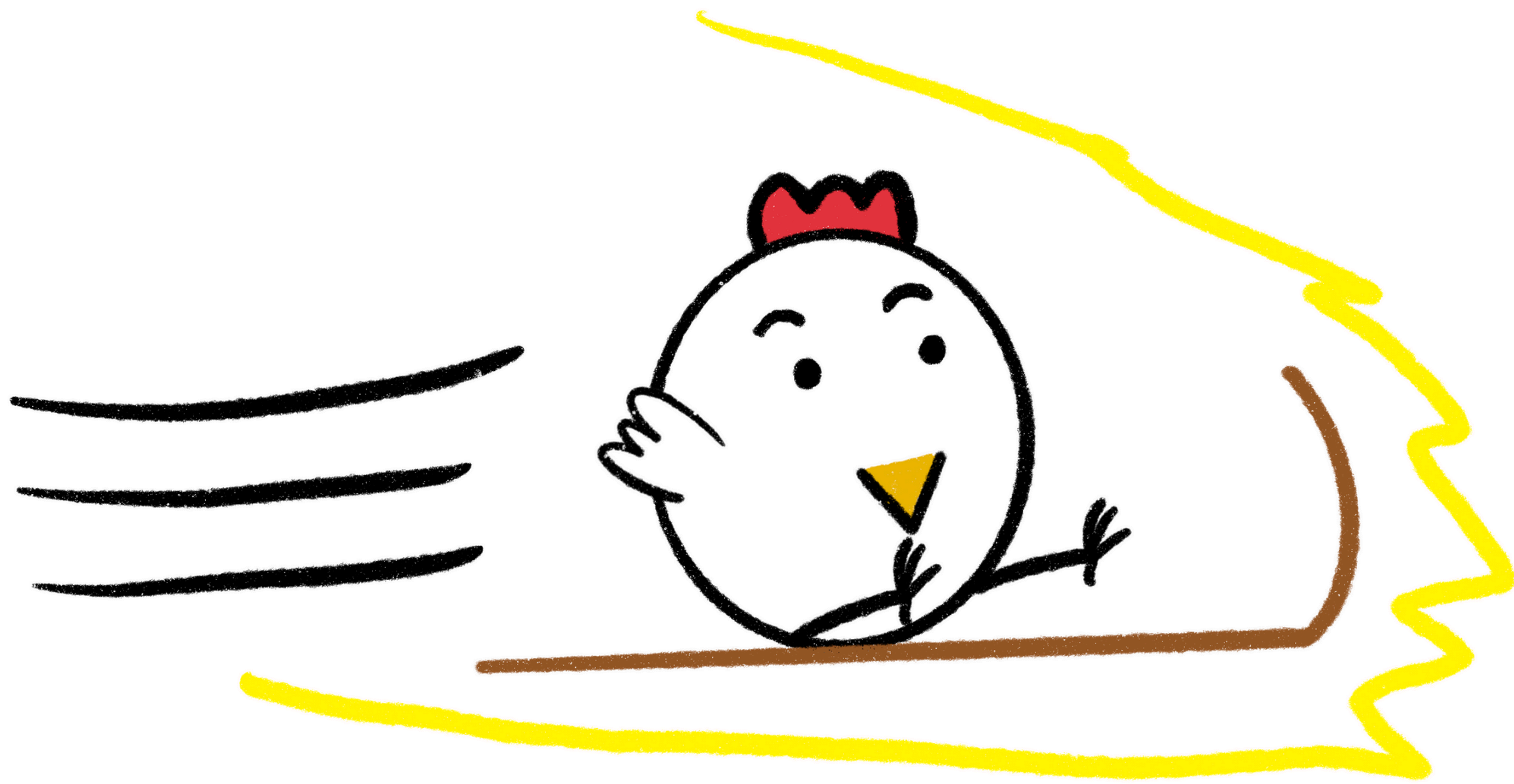
He ruffled his feathers, ready to see  
What the actual reason could possibly be.



His tickler traveler toboggan, a trusty ol' steed,  
Was put to intense, great speed.

"Where will it take me? I'm dying to know!"

The toboggan zoomed in a shimmering glow.



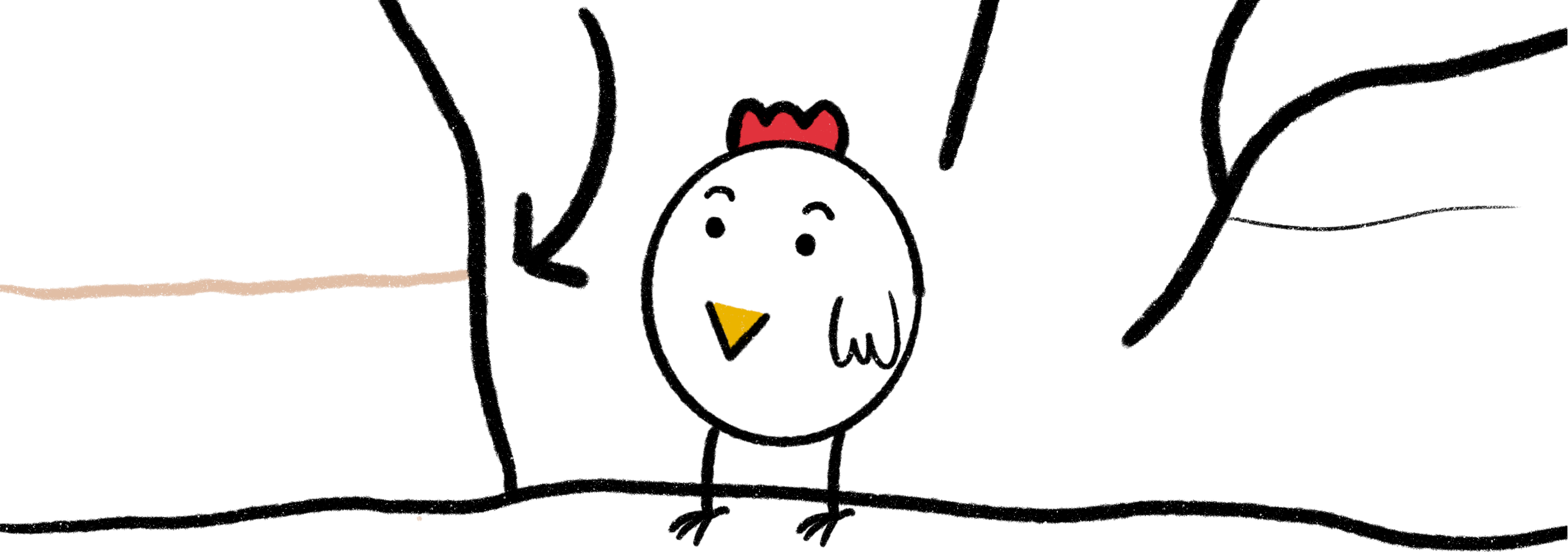
Before long Clucky found himself in solid sands.

He was in Drumheller, Alberta, Canada's dusty Badlands!



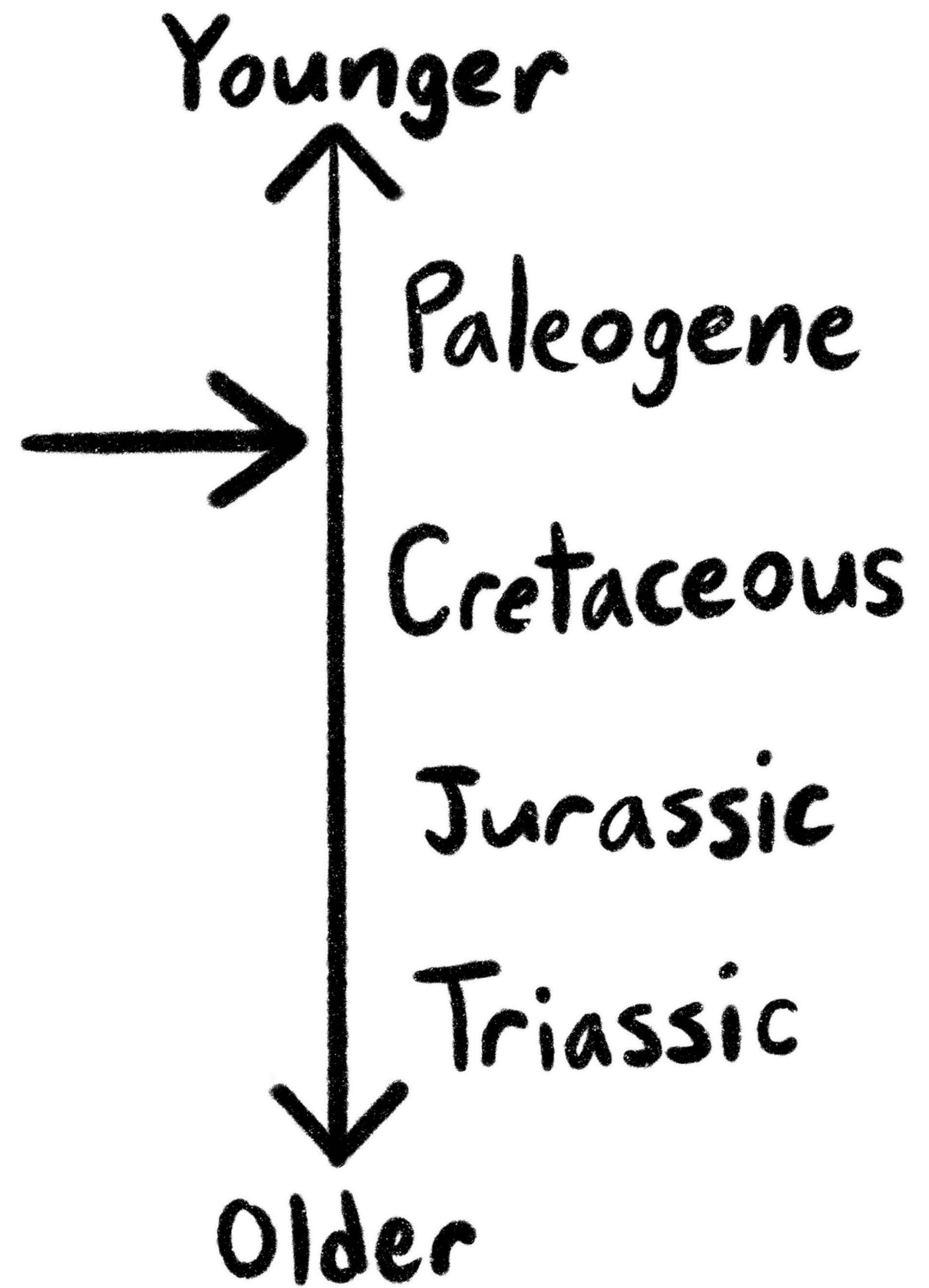
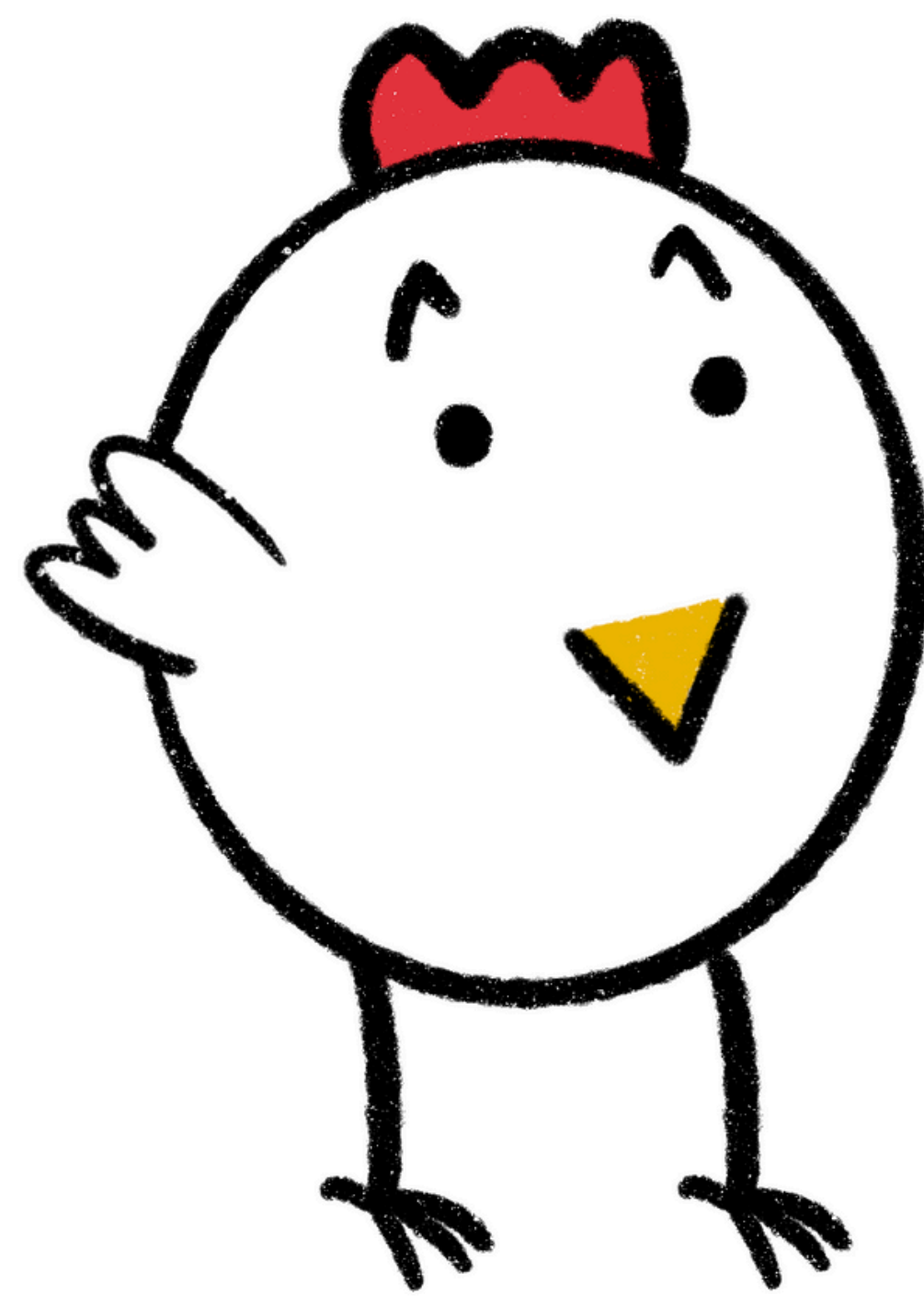
Steep slopes and hills made of rock and clay,  
"What could be the reason to be here today?"

Well Clucky, as the narrator, if I may interject,  
It would be of great value for you to inspect.  
Do you see that thin line, a true sight to adore?  
That's the K-Pg boundary for you to explore!





"The K-Pg what? Hold on, slow down.  
You're making me feel like a pitiful clown."



I apologize Clucky. I got ahead of myself.  
Let me get some info from my brain bookshelf.  
This line marks the Cretaceous my friend,  
The last period of the dinosaurs, their inevitable end.





This boundary is present everywhere, worldwide.

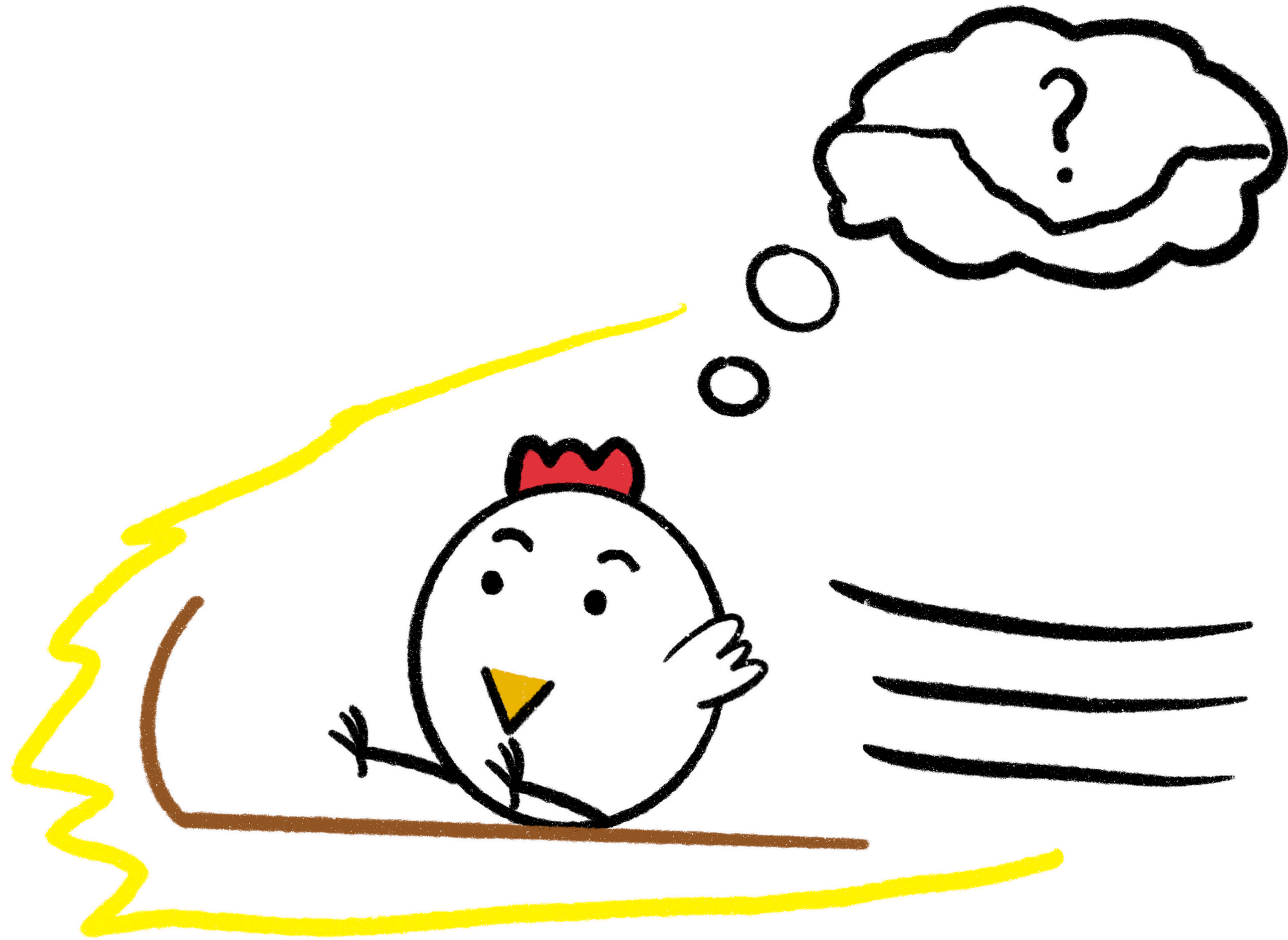
There is no place for this line to hide.

From the U.S. to France, from Japan to Spain,  
With work there is a lot of info to gain.

Analyzing this rock shows high levels of iridium,  
A very rare Earth element in any millennium.  
However, if we dare to look to the skies,  
Where asteroids are abundant like flies,  
We will find iridium aplenty as if it were candy,  
Suggesting an asteroid caused an extinction so untimely.

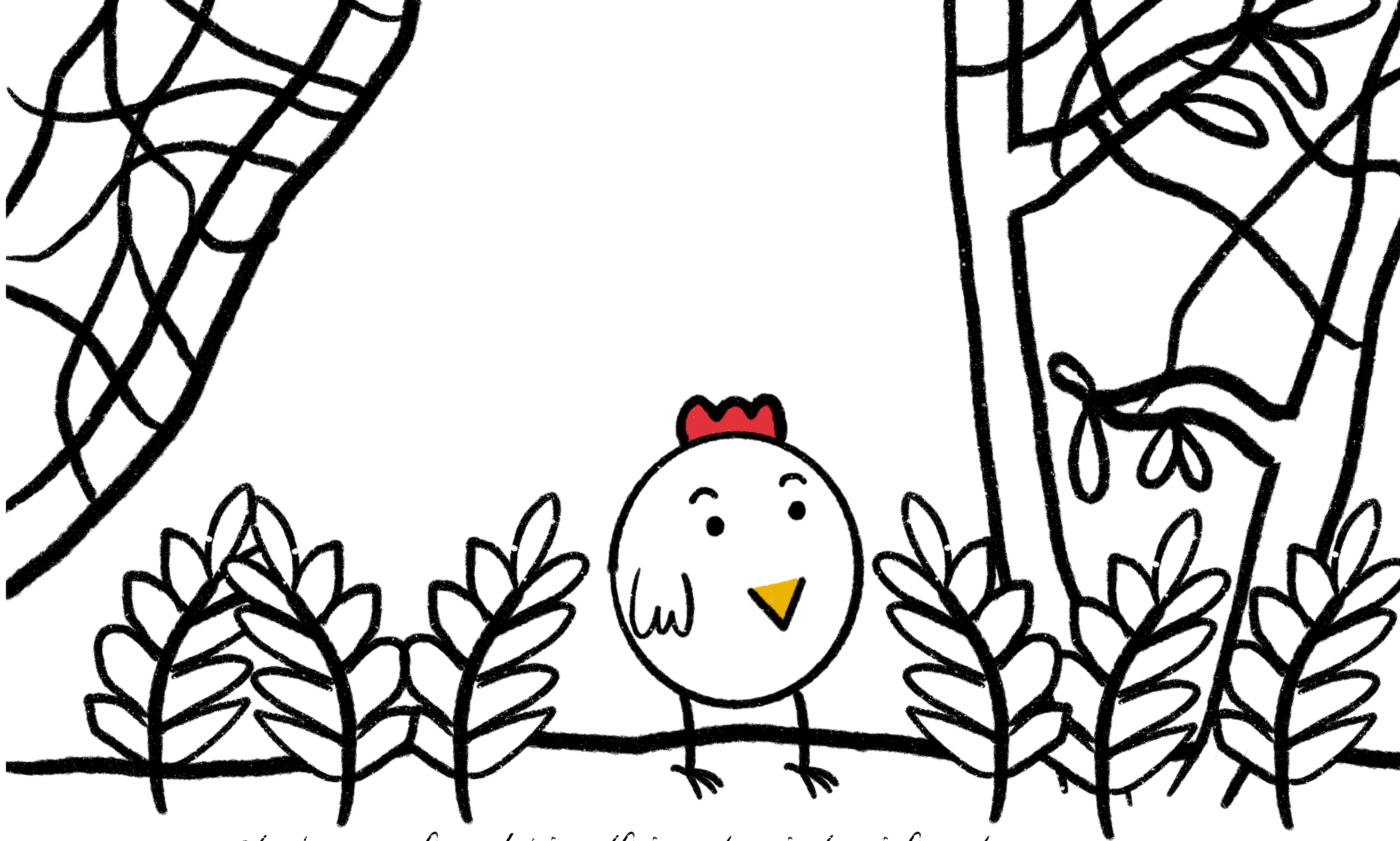


"It's certainly intriguing, but I'm not convinced at all.  
If it were true, where's the crater for the fireball?"



That's a good question, the key to the mystery.  
Let the toboggan take you to the next stop to see.



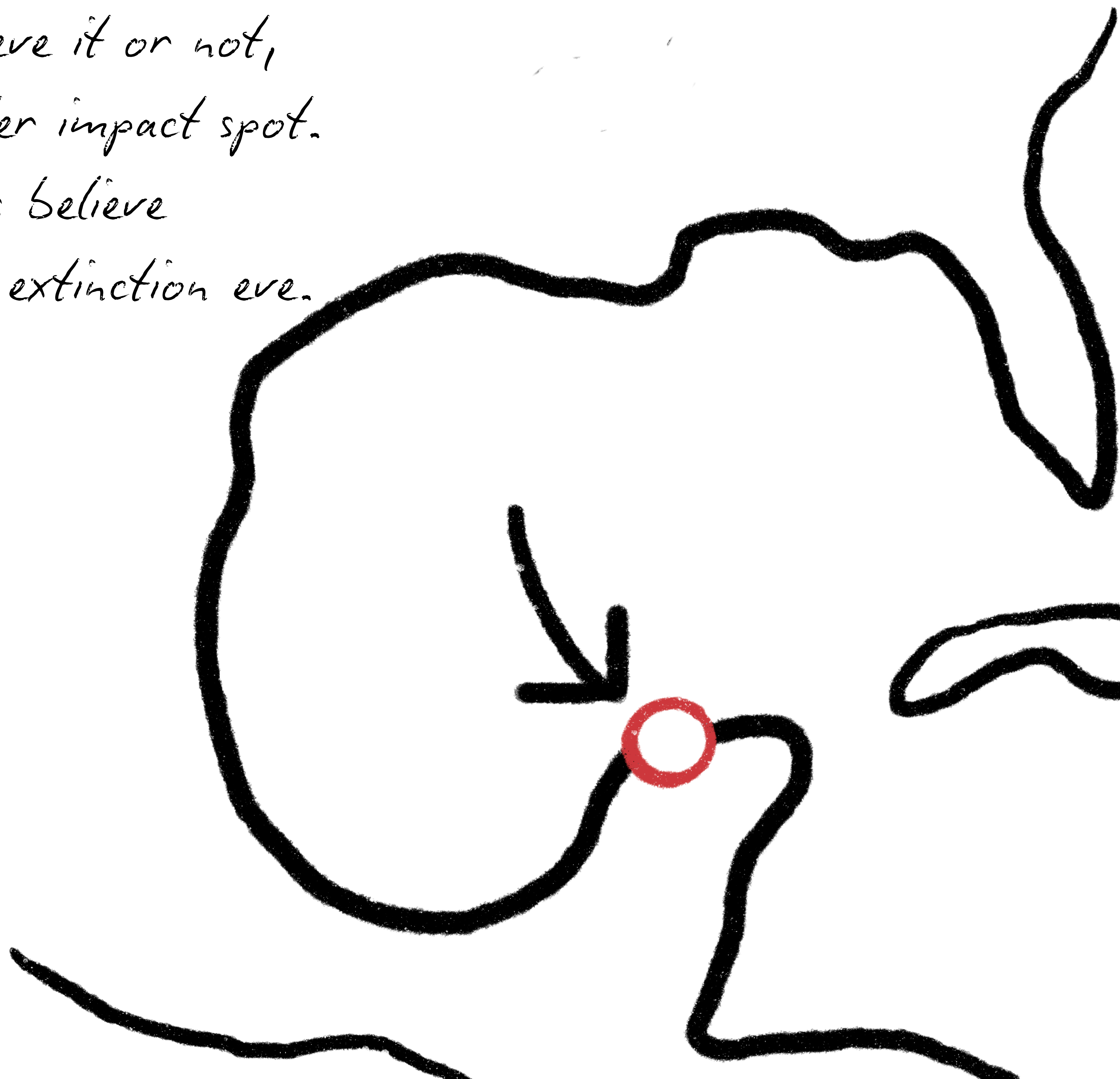


Clucky now found himself in a tropical rainforest  
With the buzzing of bugs and the singing of birds chorused.  
Truly bizarre, he thought, as rustled leaves made a slight echo.  
Make no mistake. He's in the Yucatan Peninsula, Mexico!



"Why am I in Mexico? I truly don't know.  
There is nothing here of worth to show."

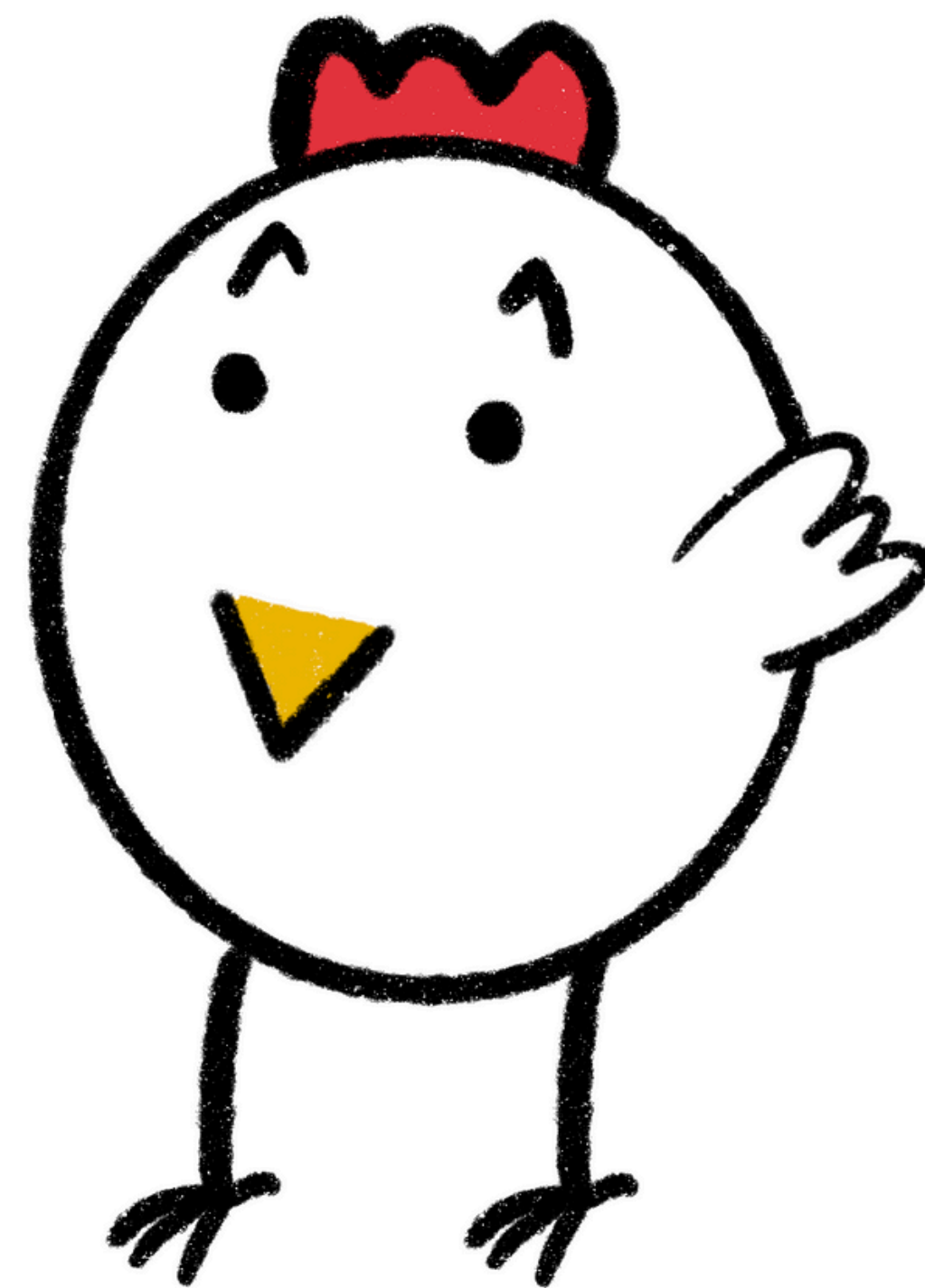
Well Clucky, my friend, believe it or not,  
You're in the Chicxulub Crater impact spot.  
This is the site where scientists believe  
An asteroid hit Earth on the extinction eve.





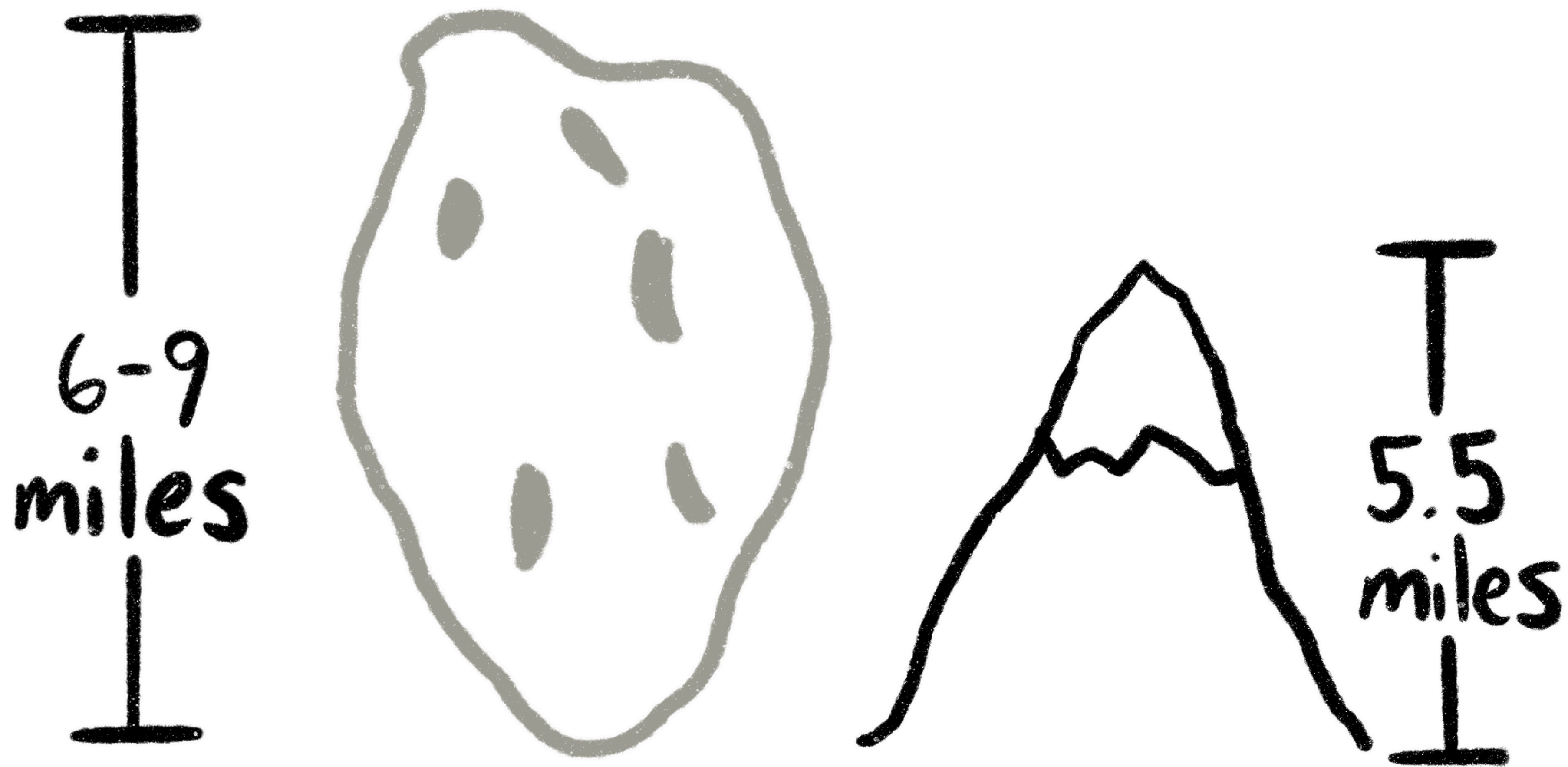
"How could anyone tell that is the case?  
All I can see is forest and ocean space"

Dig a little deeper, and you'll see with a close eye  
The presence of shocked quartz and tektites intensify.  
No Earthly geologic process can produce these.  
Only the immense pressure of an asteroid's squeeze.





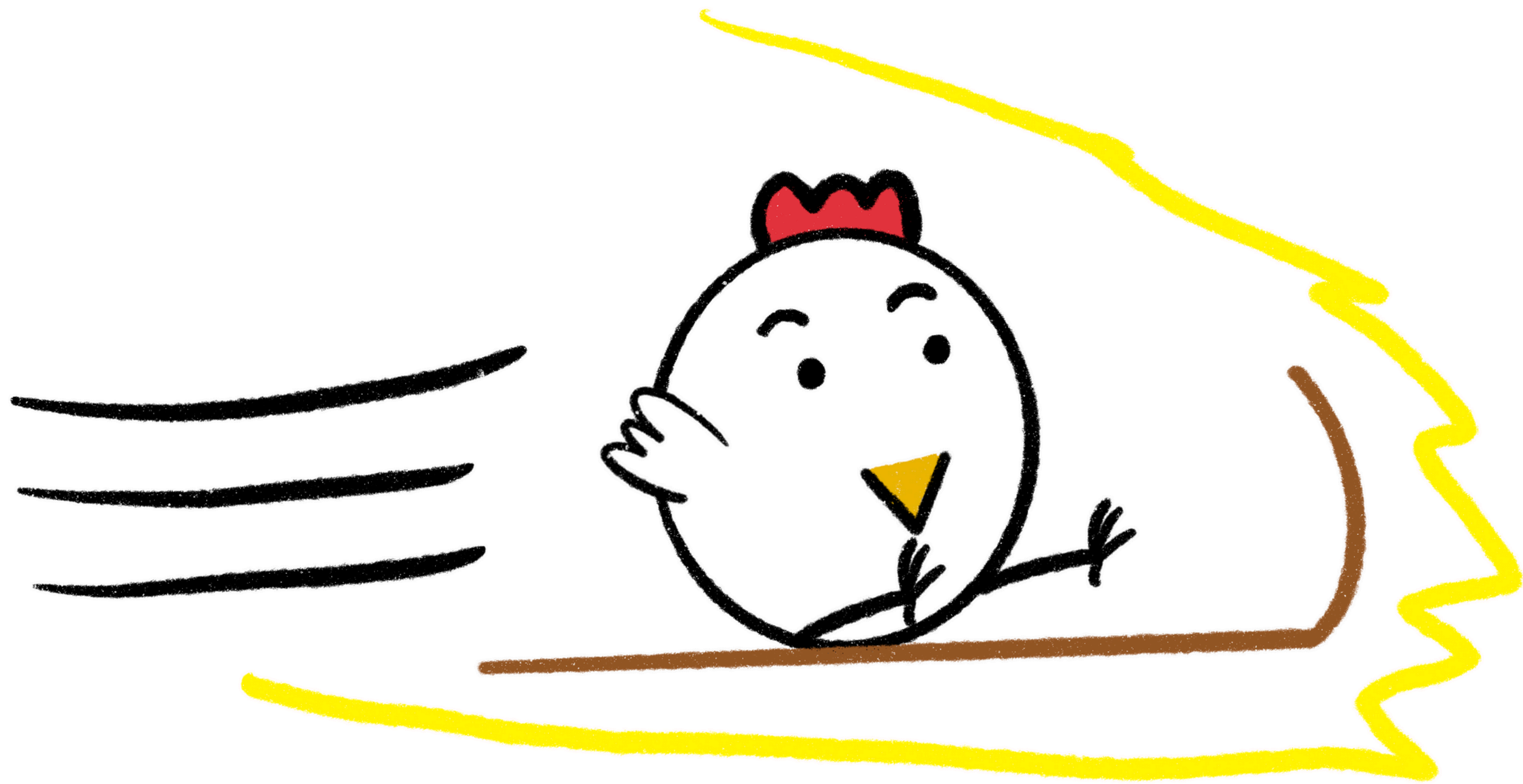
In fact, after years of research, we finally know,  
The asteroid struck Earth 66 million years ago.  
At a length of 6 to 9 miles wide,  
It would've been taller than Mount Everest, side to side!



Not only that, this fact may make you more perplexed,  
But this crater is 110 miles from one end to the next.



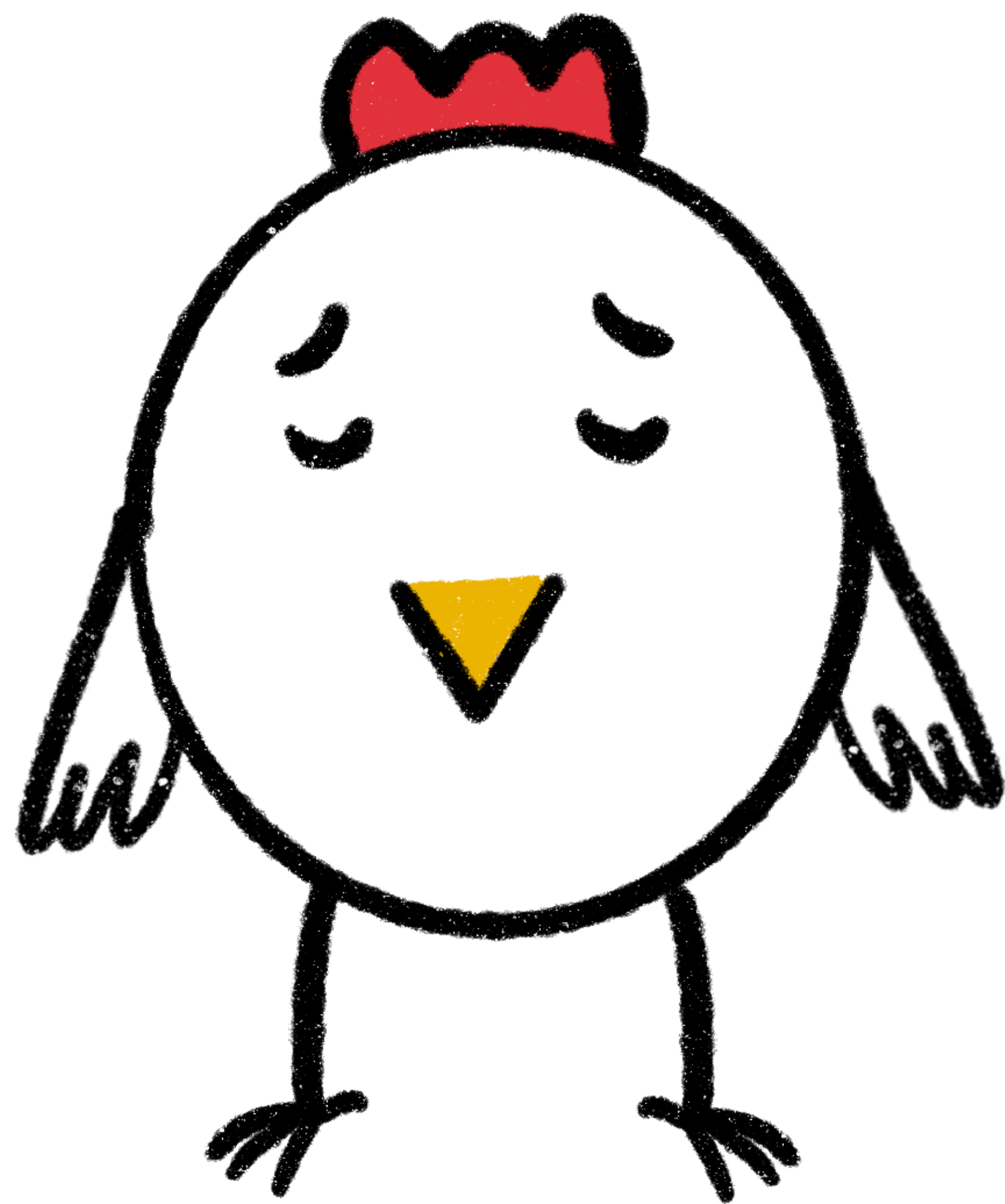
"Wow, that's amazing! Who could've known?"  
I suppose the dinosaurs, who are now all bones.



Have you had your curiosity pleasantly satisfied?  
"I sure did. Let me head back home on this ride."

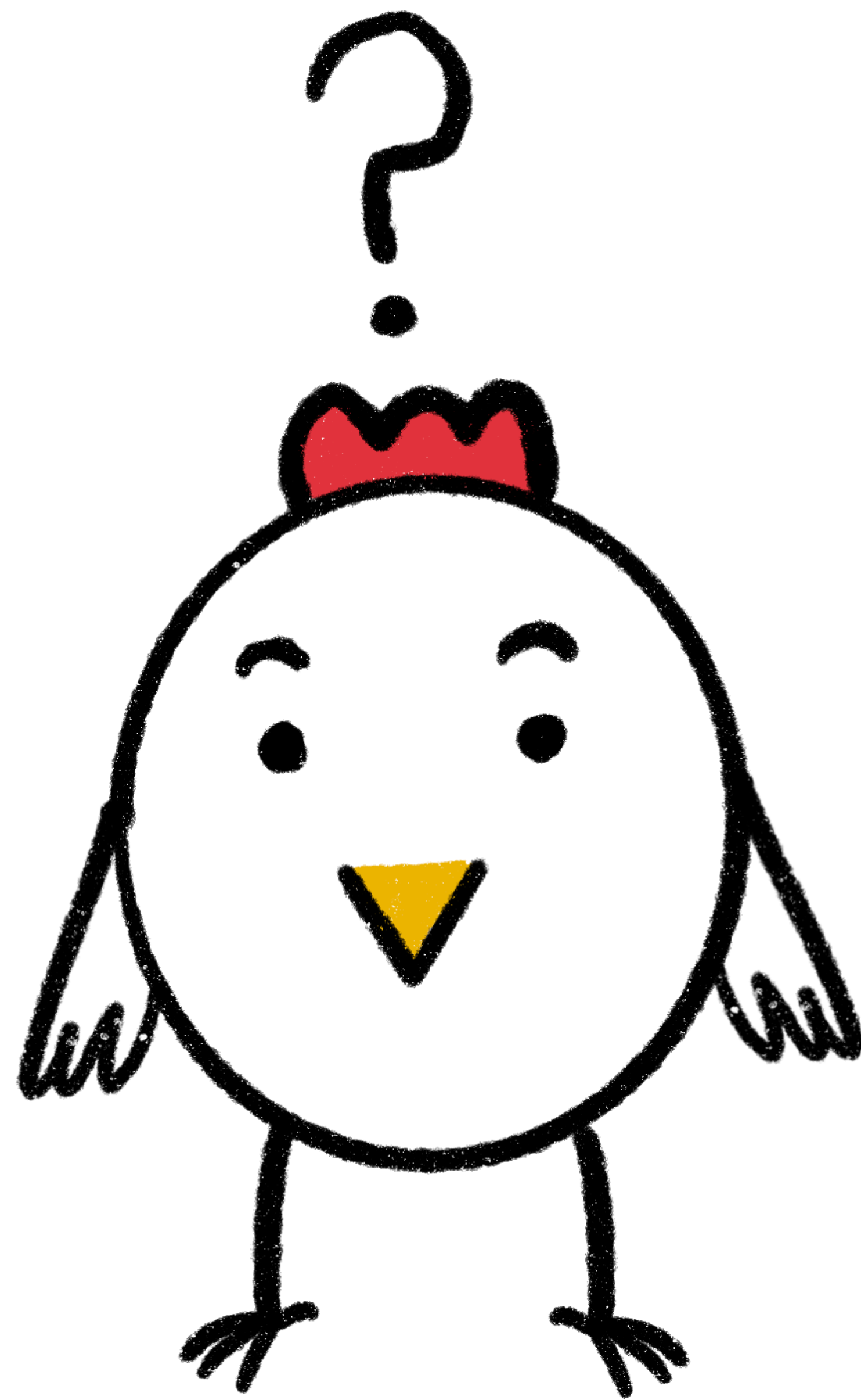


"You know Mr. Narrator? I'm still quite depressed.  
All the dinosaurs are still gone and really, really dead."





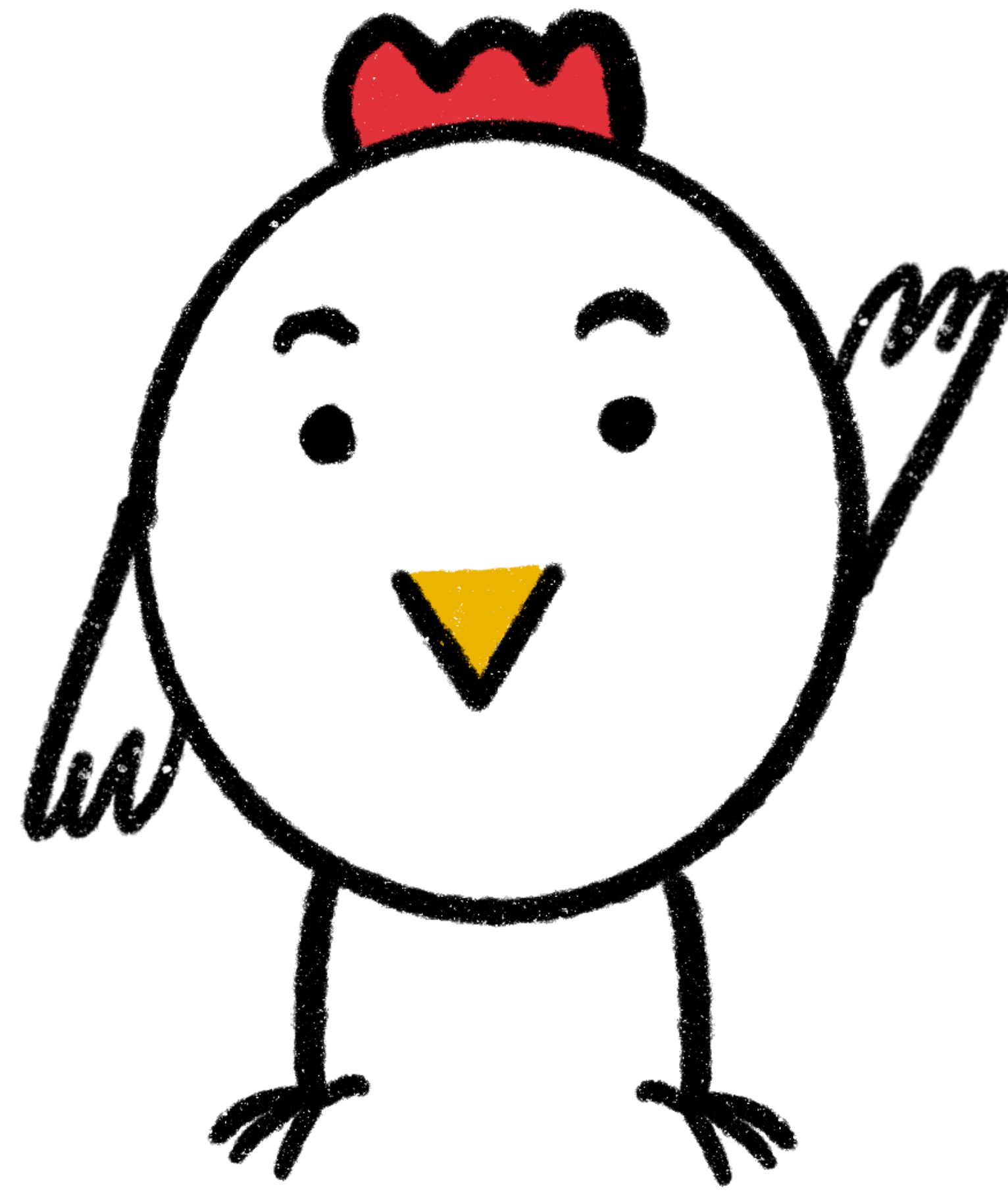
Let me tell you something to cheer up your soul.  
Dinosaurs still do exist. You just didn't know!





"Dinosaurs are alive? What do you mean?"

Just look in a mirror to be finally serene.

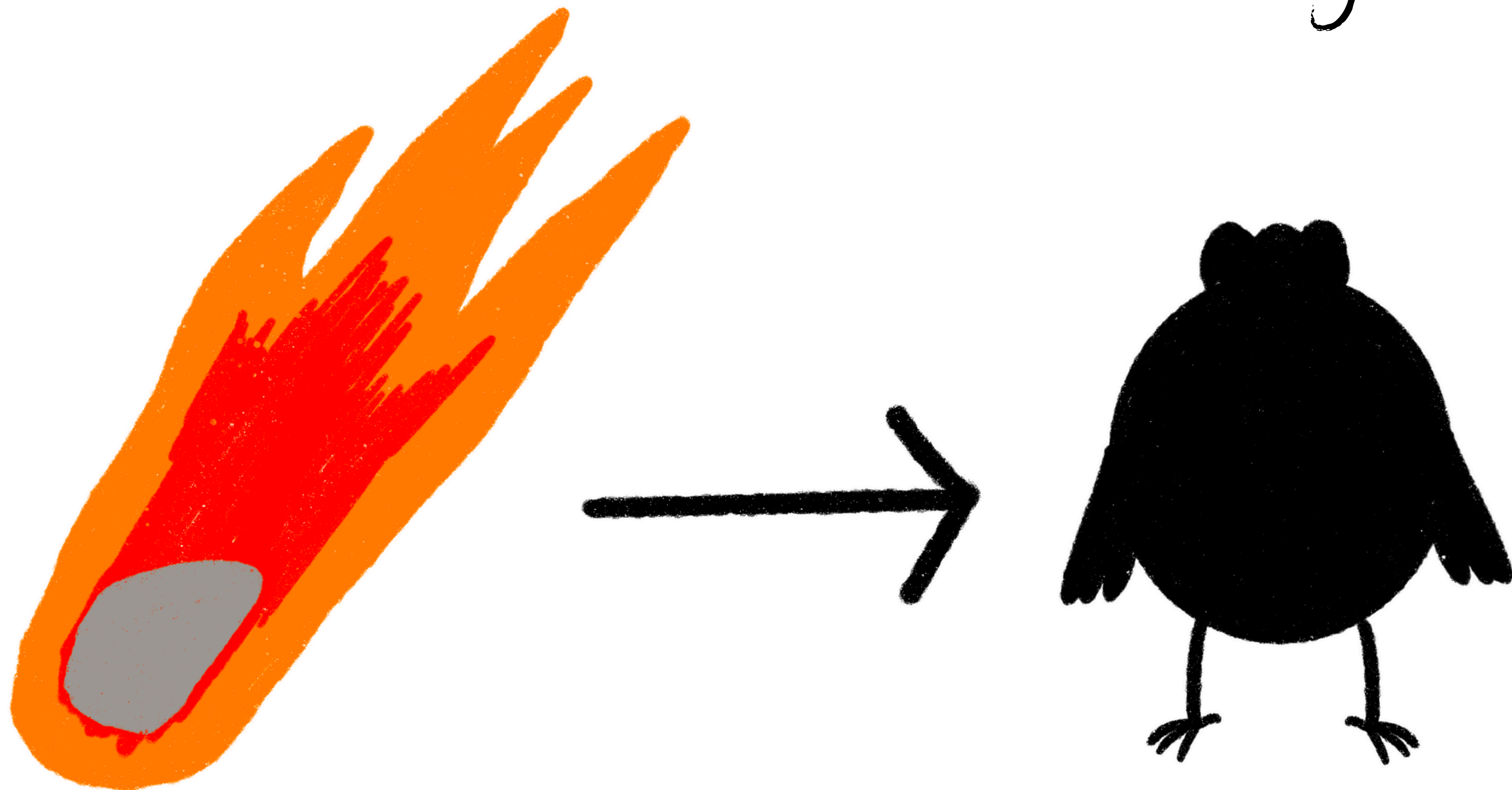


"Are you saying dinosaurs are actually me?"

Indeed I am. They are birds. Really!

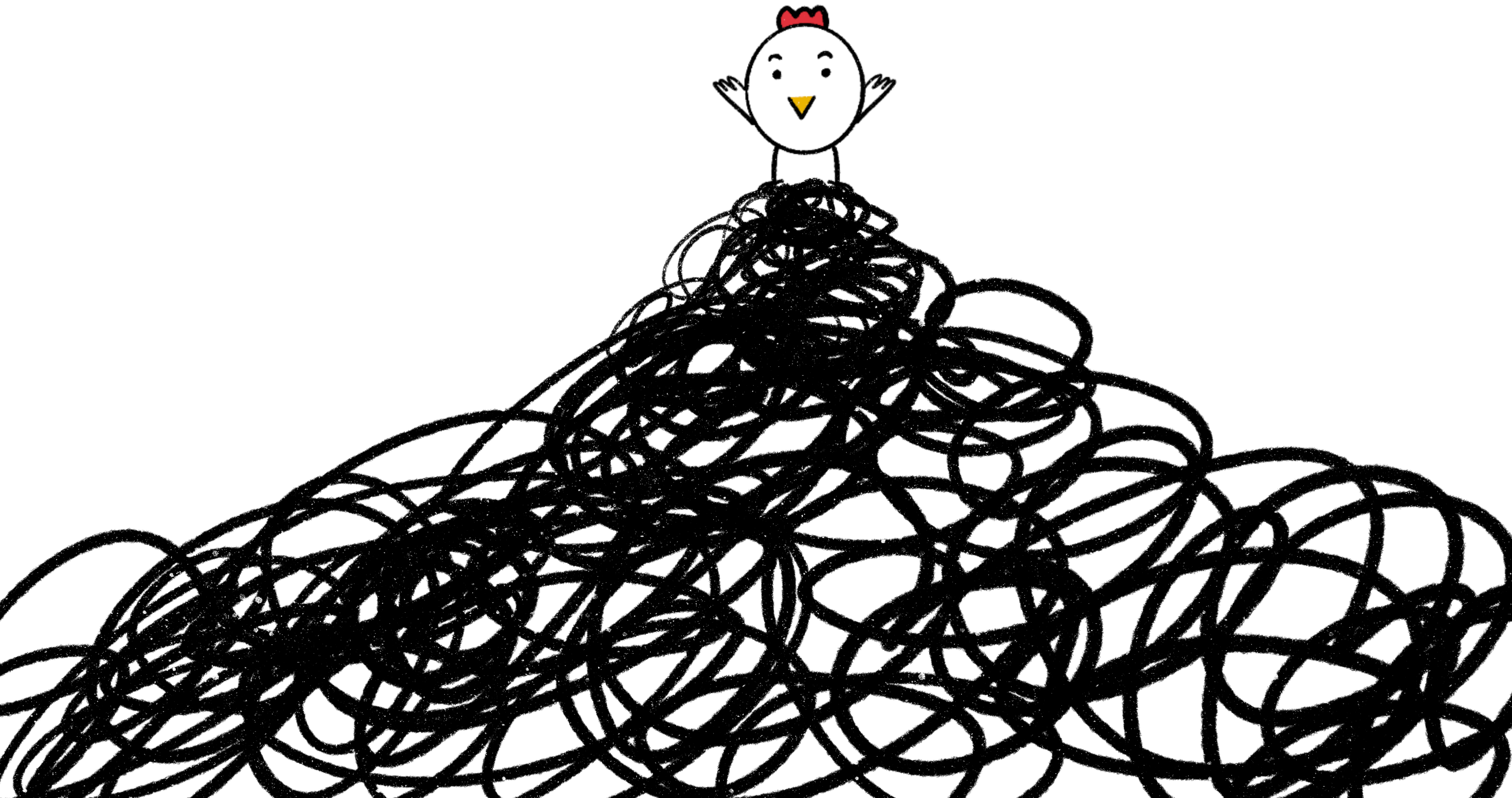


Out of the chaos from the impact that ensued,  
From tsunamis to earthquakes and survival fends  
To eruptions, intense heat, and dust no one braved,  
Only one type of dinosaur made it out unscathed.  
That dinosaur is birds, just like you to the core.  
You're a direct descendant of a lineage with lore.



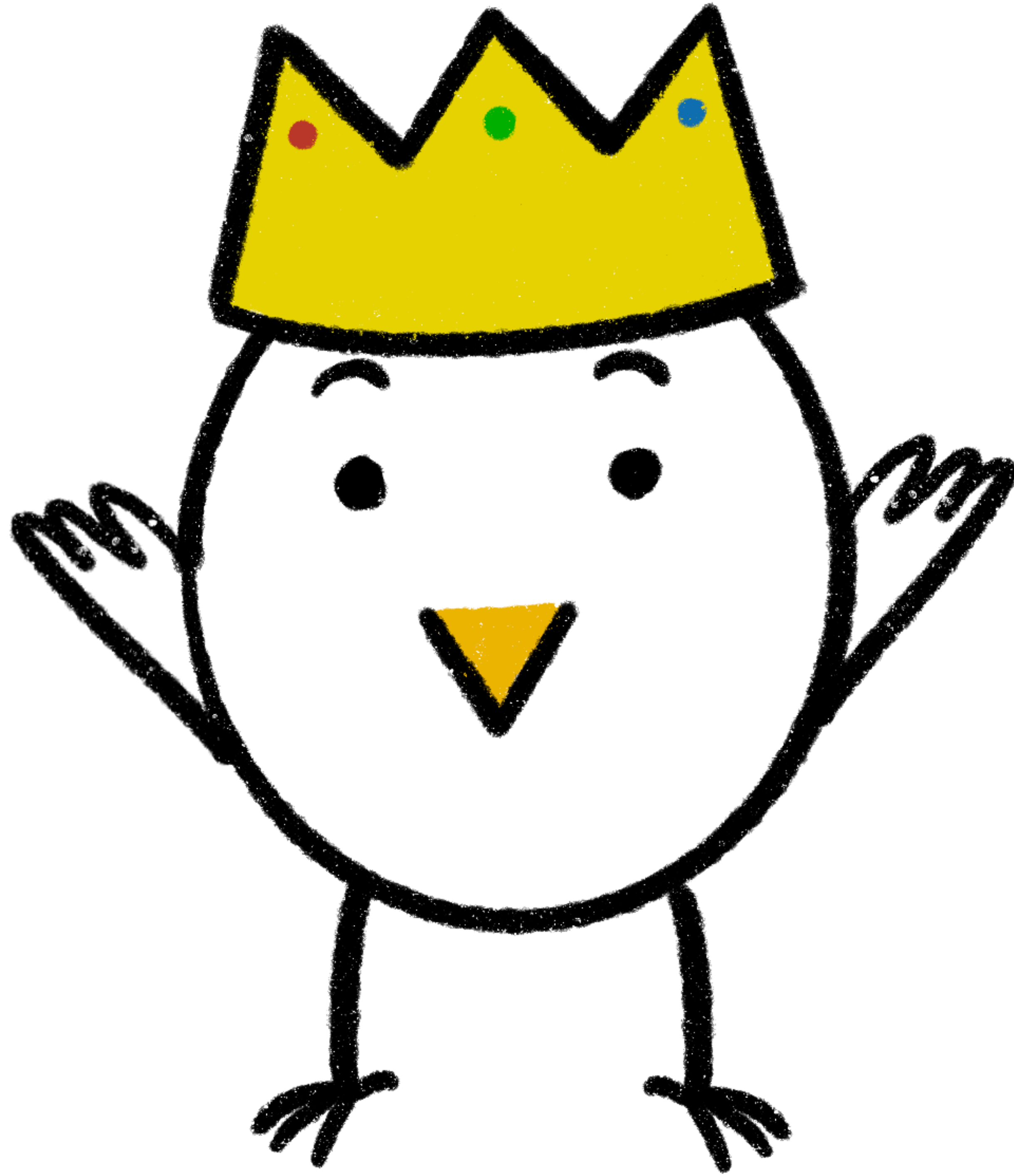


You may be small, but that is truly no matter.  
You come from the survivors of the biggest disaster.





That mighty T-rex is living in you.



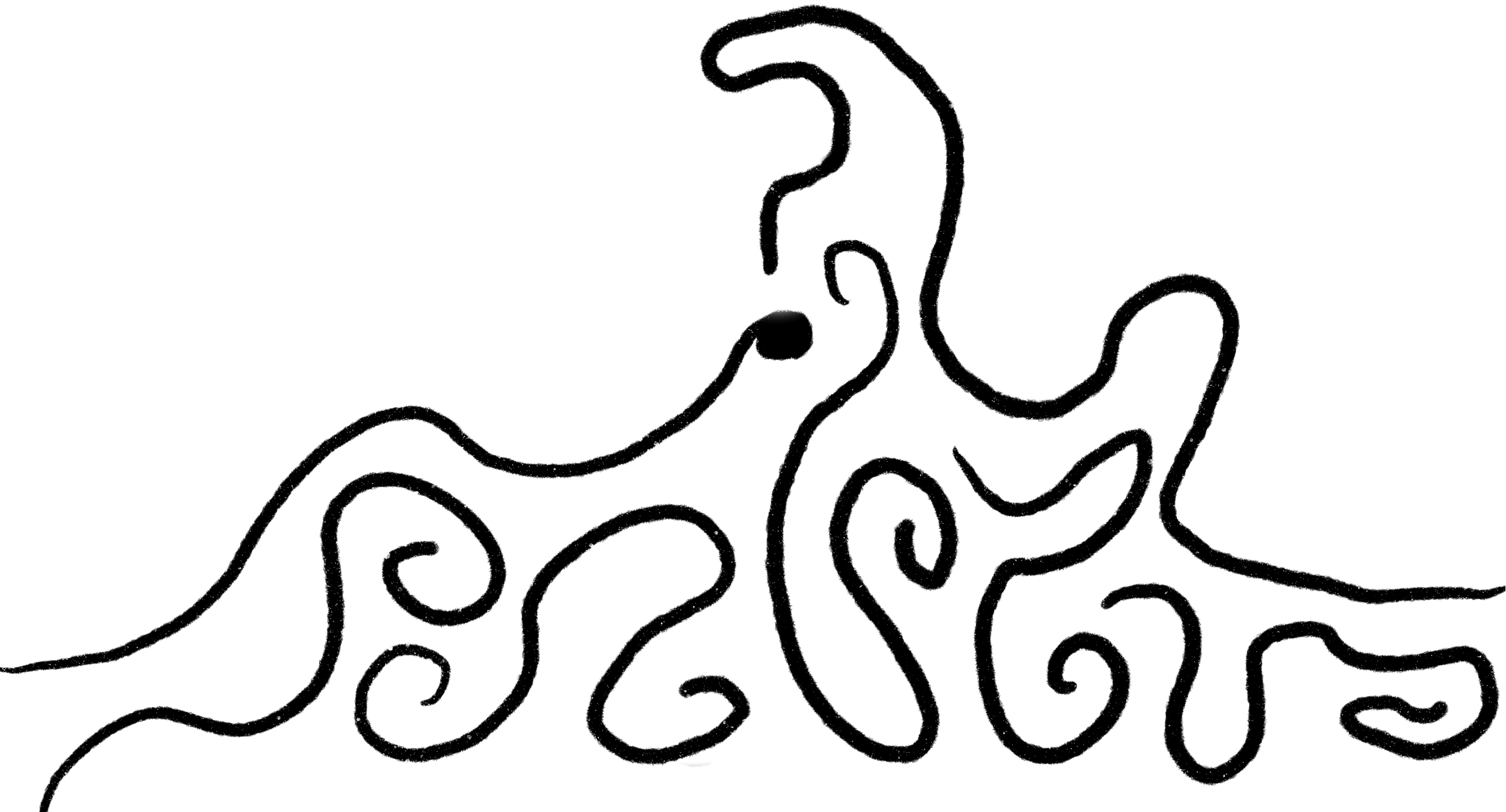
All hail King Clucky! Farewell and adieu!



I see you the reader are vying for more.

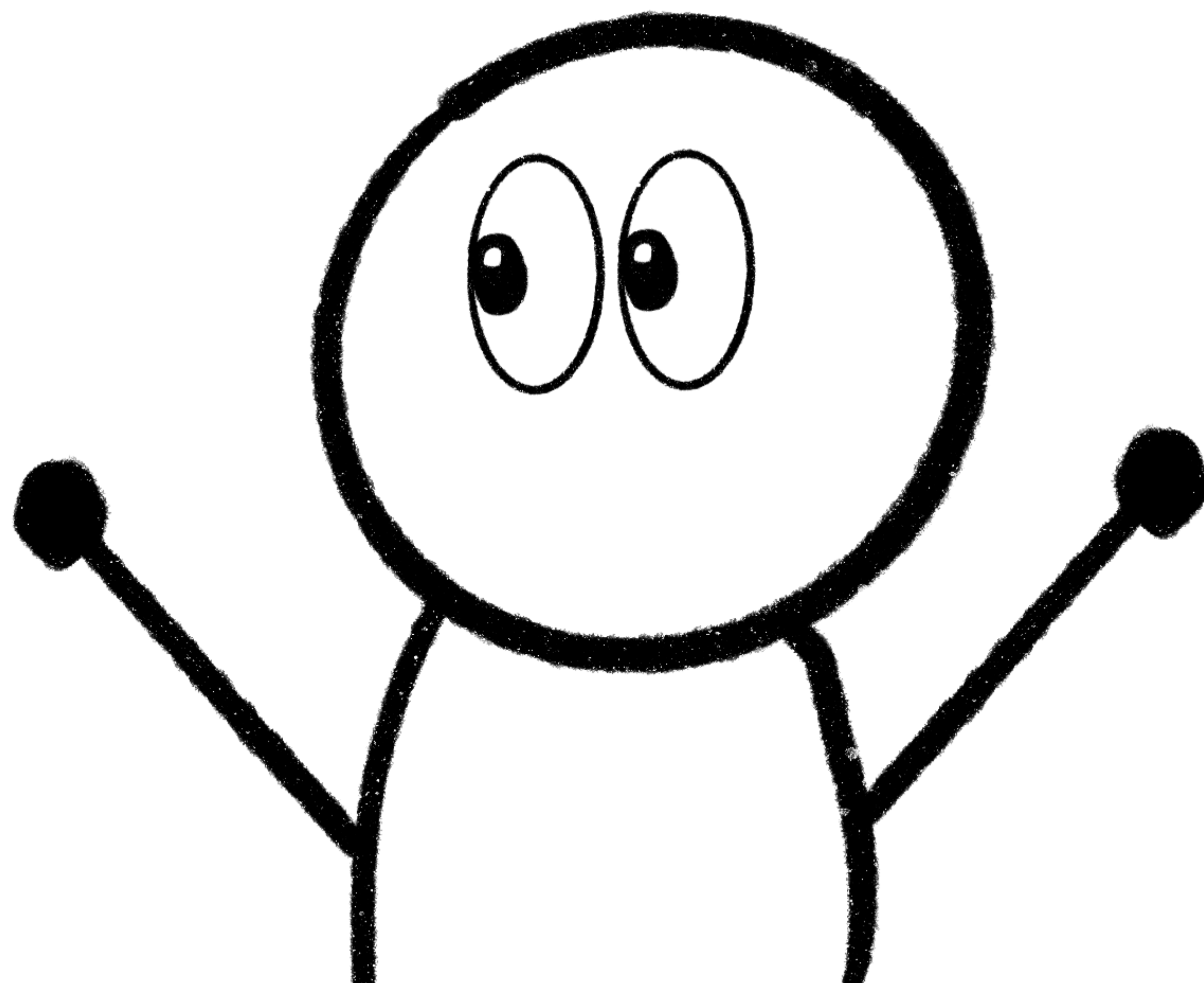
Who am I? Well, that's a question I just can't ignore.

I lurk in the shadows, filling my noggin with joy.



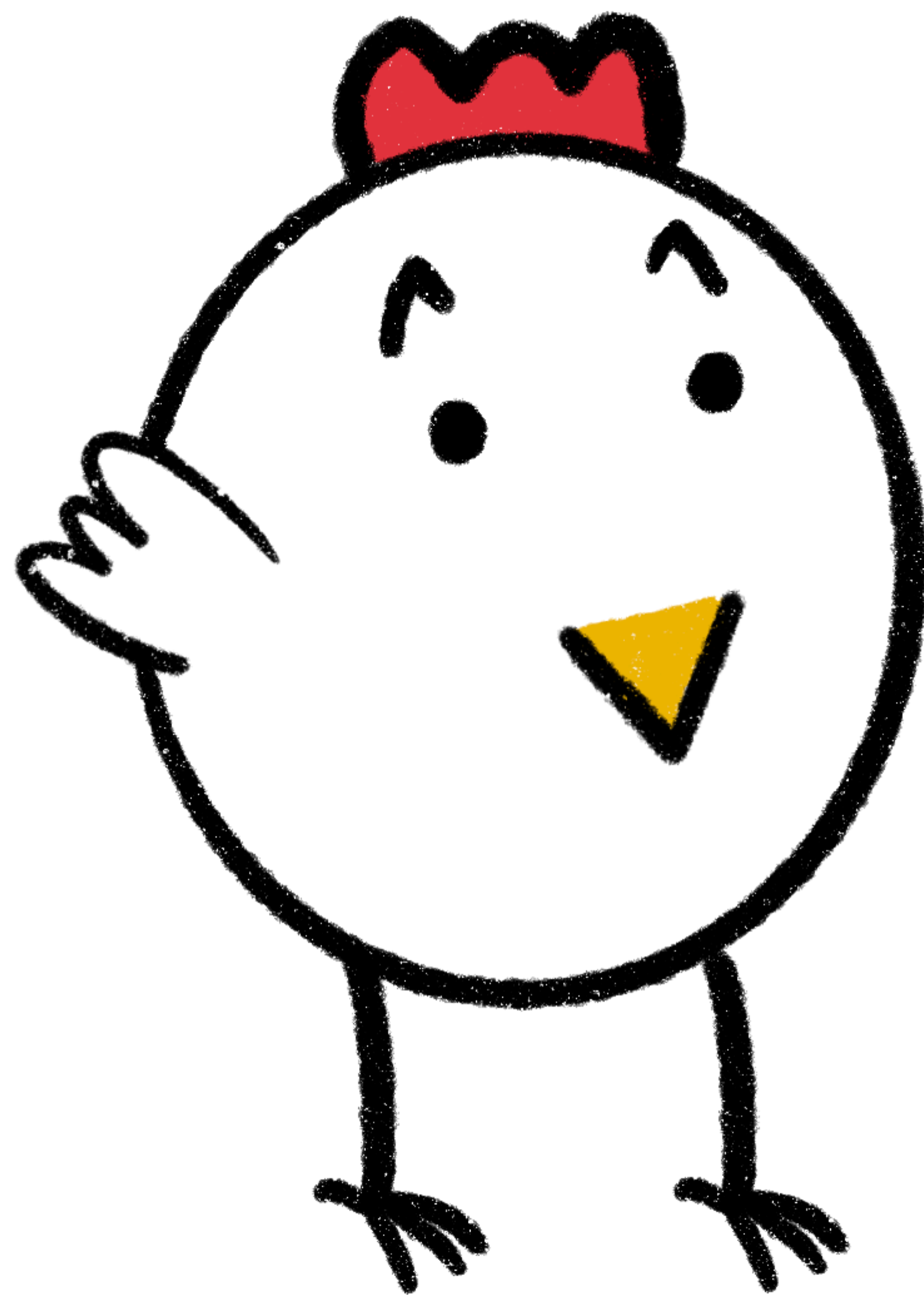


That's right. My name is Gussy the Genius Boy!



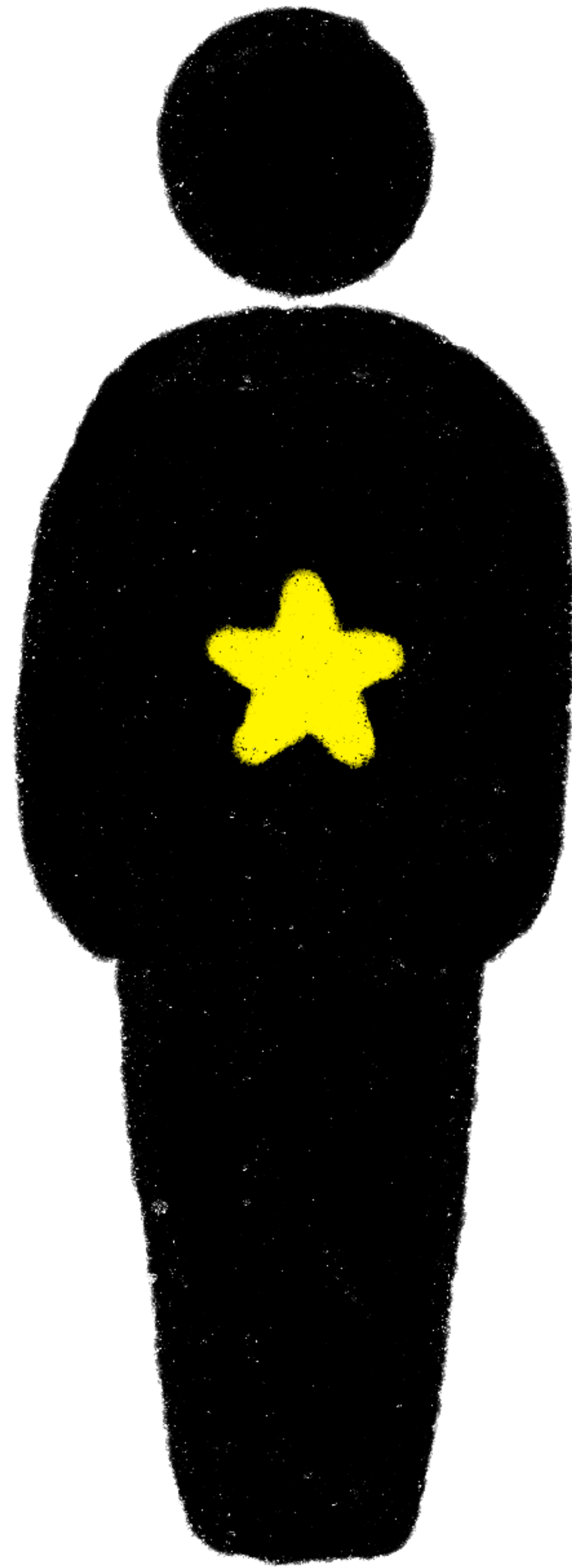


I truly hoped you enjoyed our adventure today.  
Clucky is no longer filled with dismay.





Until next time, dear reader, please remember this:



We are all worthy inside. We each have a reason we exist.



